

dropped 10.1 per cent, while notebook PC shipments recorded a growth of 31.5 per cent on a year-on-year basis.

"The home and SMB segments recorded the lowest drop (in percentage terms) in CY 2008 vis-a-vis CY 2007. The measures announced by the RBI to free up credit are expected to revive demand from these segment and a moderate recovery in shipments may result during the second half of CY 2009," said Sumanta Mukherjee, lead analyst, computing products research, IDC India.

Worldwide PC shipments down 6.5 per cent in Q1

According to market research firm Gartner, worldwide PC shipments totalled 67.2 million units in the first quarter of 2009—a 6.5 per cent decline over the first quarter of 2008.

Hewlett-Packard (HP) extended its lead in the worldwide PC market, accounting for 19.8 per cent of global shipments. It registered higher growth rates than the regional averages in the US, Asia/Pacific, and Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA). HP's strength derived from its solid consumer PC portfolio, including low-priced mobile PCs.

Dell and Acer finished the quarter in a virtual tie for the No. 2 position in the worldwide PC market.

Worldwide semiconductor sales decline in 2008

Worldwide semiconductor revenue totalled \$255 billion in 2008—down 5.4 per cent from 2007 revenue. According to Gartner, the steep decline in the market in the final quarter of 2008, combined with the ongoing economic weakness, signals far worse declines in 2009.

Intel held the No. 1 position for the 17th consecutive year, increasing its market share to 13.3 per cent in 2008, although it saw its revenue decline by 0.5 per cent. It outperformed the industry average due to the strong performance of its notebook business in which the company gained share throughout the year.

The best performer amongst the

2008 top 10 in Gartner's market share analysis was Qualcomm, with growth of 15.3 per cent.

Samsung, the No. 2 vendor, saw its revenue decline 15 per cent in 2008 with the company's main product lines—DRAM and NAND flash—experiencing sharp price declines caused by excess supply in the market during 2008.

Toshiba, in the No. 3 position, saw its revenue decrease 10.3 per cent, largely because its application-specific integrated circuits and application-specific standard products for consumer, wireless and automotive electronics showed mild growth in early 2008.

Electronics giants expect green screens to boost sales

Due to the ongoing global recession, the demand for LCD and plasma TVs is sinking. In a bid to defend their market shares, players like Sony, Panasonic and Sony are coming up with new features to distinguish their products from those of their competitors. They are banking heavily on eco-friendly TVs to attract buyers and boost profits in difficult economic times.

Flat-screen sets, like the new Sharp Aquos, are environmentally friendlier as these use less energy and cost less to run. "Environment-friendly functions are a premium that the consumers will pay for," says Emi Nagahara, a product planner for Sony's TV business group. "These will be a standard for all LCD TVs," she predicts.

No IMEI, no mobile connection

About 25 million handsets are estimated to have been out of service from April 15, 2009. Showing its concern over the national security, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has asked telecom operators to disconnect services to handsets that do not have an IMEI number. IMEI is a 15-digit code which appears on the operator's network whenever a call is made. This announcement will surely bring Chinese mobiles to death in India.

11-digit mobile numbers soon

By next year, India will start using the 11-digit mobile phone numbers, with the subscriber base limit of 450 million for 10-digit numbers expected to get breached by then.

The only two other countries to use 11-digit mobile numbers at present are China, whose subscriber base of 624.16 million (as in January) is far ahead of India, and the UK, which uses it apparently for technical reasons as its subscriber base is much lower.

Digi-Link unveils new logo

Digi-Link, which was introduced as a structured cabling brand from D-Link India in 2004, has announced various



initiatives to reinforce the brand in the global market commencing with unveiling of a new brand identity.

Last year in October, D-Link India had announced its de-merger into two separate entities that would focus on active products under D-Link brand and passive products under Digi-Link brand. Post de-merger announcement, there has been an increased focus on positioning Digi-Link as an independent SCS brand and thus the need for creating a new brand identity emerged.

"With the emerging focus on Digi-Link, it was of critical importance to have a unique brand identity with an international look and feel. Our new logo for Digi-Link ensures the core brand values," stated Jangoo Dalal, managing director and chief executive officer, D-Link India.

Philips eyes tier-II and tier-III markets

Philips Electronics India expects to roll out its new range by September to coincide with the festive season.

"The strategy is to develop products that can compete with those available in the unorganised sector.